METRIC

A-A-59489
September 22, 1999

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MATCHES, SAFETY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification EE-M-101J.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers safety matches, in books or boxes, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, local governments and other interested parties, and as a component of operational rations.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The matches shall conform to the following types and classes as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types and classes.

Type I - Paper

Class A - 20 splint book
Class B - 10 splint book

Type II - Wood

Class A - Large, "kitchen" size sticks
Class B - Small, "pocket" size sticks

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, Defense Supply Center Philadelphia, ATTN: DSCP-HSL, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5092 or FAX (215) 737-2963.

AMSC N/A **FSC 9920**

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Splints/Sticks: Type I paper match splints shall be made of splint board. Type II wooden match sticks shall be made of a good grade, long-fibered timber. The splints and sticks shall not be broken, split, crushed, adhering, chipped, or cracked.

3.2 Match head: The head material of the safety matches shall be evenly applied over the ends and sides of splints and sticks to facilitate ignition.

3.3 Dimensions: Type I, Class A and Class B paper match splint with head shall measure 35± 3 mm (1-3/8 ± 1/8 inches), and the total length of splint with head and base shall be 48 mm ± 3 mm (1-7/8 inches ± 1/8 inches) in length. Type I, Class A shall be 30 ± 2 mm (1-3/16 ± 1/16 inches) in width. Type I, Class B shall be 16 mm ± 2 mm (5/8 ± 1/16 inches) in width. Type II, Class A wooden stick with head shall measure 60 ± 3 mm (2-3/8 ± 1/8 inches) in length and 2½ mm (.10 inch) in width. Type II, Class B wooden stick with head shall measure 44 ± 3 mm (1-3/4 ± 1/8 inches) in length and 2 mm (.08 inch) in width.

3.4 Count: Type I, Class A paper matches shall be 20 matches per book, with 10 splints on each of two rows. Type I, Class B paper matches shall be10 matches per book, with 5 splints on each of two rows. The average number of Type II, Class A wooden matches shall be not less than 250 per box and no box shall contain less than 230 matches. The average number of Type II, Class B wooden matches shall be not less than 32 per box and no box shall contain less than 30 matches.

3.5 Striking surface: The striking surface on the outside match book or box shall be coated with a preparation which will be used to ignite the matches when they are rapidly drawn across the specially prepared surface. The striking surface shall not peel or rub off.

3.6 Performance: The matches shall be manufactured to function as small, portable, clean and uniform, ignition devices. Both match types shall ignite readily and burn fiercely without breakage of the splint/stick or head, or without cracking, exploding or afterglow. The matches shall only be ignited by friction when struck on a match book or box cover's specially prepared striking surface. Matches shall provide a source of fire as well as to provide short term illumination. The matches shall light in damp conditions.

3.7 Performance test: One hundred matches shall be tested. Each match shall be struck on the striking surface until it ignites or becomes damaged. Five or more failures shall result in rejection of the lot.

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3.8 Humidity resistance test: One hundred matches shall be placed in a saturated humidity chamber maintained at approximately 39^0C (105^0 F). Matches shall be conditioned in the chamber for 6 hours. Immediately upon removal from the chamber, each match shall be struck on the striking surface until it ignites or becomes damaged. Thirty or more failures shall result in rejection of the lot.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 U. S. Department of Transportation. The offeror/contractor shall comply with all regulations and requirements of the U. S. Department of Transportation , and all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations regarding safety matches.

4.2 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Subpart 23.403 to the maximum extent practical.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The safety matches shall meet the physical characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same safety matches offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units. Dimensions and tolerances specified shall be converted using conversion tables contained in IEEE/ASTM SI Standard for Use of the International System of Units (SI): The Modern Metric System.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Types and classes required.

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7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Requirements for the transportation of hazardous materials is found in 49 CFR Parts 171 to 180. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1803 or on **the Internet at: http://www.nara.gov/fedreg.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L 'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS: ACTIVITIES:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING

GSA - 7FXE
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DLA - SS

(Project 9920-0021)

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